TRIAGE CARD v1

A consistent triage habit for the first few minutes of a case — from signal to decision with less confusion and less drift.

ALERT BASICS

Source: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint

Rule or detection name: 'Yomal' malware was detected on a domain controller

Time (UTC): 2026-11-04 07:46:35 UTC

Asset: mts-dc

User: MTS\administrator

Business owner: IT Infrastructure / Identity Services

Business sensitivity: Critical - Domain Controller

FIRST QUESTIONS

What is the signal trying to tell me: Malware was detected on a domain controller.

Is this alert already known, duplicated, or previously handled: Not verified. Duplicates and prior handling not reviewed.

Is the activity still active: WinRAR created the flagged file; no subsequent execution observed. Ongoing activity unverified.

Is this one user or host, or more than one: The alert identifies one user account and one host. Broader scope remains unverified.

Does this touch a sensitive account, team, or system: Yes. Critical domain controller; `MTS\administrator` privileges unverified.

FAST ENRICHMENT

Identity: MTS\administrator observed; account privileges not independently verified.

Endpoint: WinRAR.exe created gm.exe; 40/72 VirusTotal detections. Execution and containment unverified.

Network or DNS: Not assessed. related network and DNS activity not verified.

Email: No email evidence identified; delivery method unknown.

Recent change or maintenance window: Not assessed. Approved changes and maintenance history not verified.

Known business explanation: No verified business justification for suspicious activity on the domain controller.

SEVERITY CHECK

Severity: High

WHY

Fidelity: 2 · Malicious file created from WinRAR executable; WinRAR ran from administrator folder

Scope: 2 · Domain Controller

Business impact: 2 · Significant risk to Active Directory security

Urgency: 2 · Critical Asset

DECISION

Escalate

ACTIONS TAKEN

1. Reviewed process telemetry; confirmed WinRAR created the flagged file.

2. Verified file hash in VirusTotal; 40/72 vendors flagged it as malicious.

3. Provided evidence and recommended endpoint review to verify execution and containment needs.

TWO SENTENCE UPDATE

What happened: At 2026-11-04 07:46:35 UTC, WinRAR created `gm.exe` on `mts-dc`; VirusTotal flagged it as malicious (40/72 vendors).

What I did, what I need, and next decision time: Escalation recommended to verify execution, containment, and further activity; next update pending assignment.

OPEN QUESTIONS

1. Was the malicious file executed after being created?

2. Was the malicious file blocked, quarantined, or removed?

3. Who initiated the remote session, and was the activity authorized?

SMALL IMPROVEMENT AFTER CASE

Detection: Clarify file creation versus execution in alerts.

Workflow: Standardize malware execution and containment checks

Communication: Highlight confirmed findings, unknowns, and next steps in handoffs.